

Come, go, bring, and take

Learner workbook

Describe movement from a clear point of view.

Understand the distinction

Come often describes movement toward the speaker, listener, or an agreed meeting place. Go commonly describes movement away or toward another place. Bring and take describe similar movement with a person or thing.

The viewpoint can be a future location. On the phone, I am coming to your office treats the listener as the destination. Bring your notes to our meeting uses the shared meeting as the reference point. Context can make more than one choice natural.

Compare the patterns

TOWARD US

Can you come to my desk?

The speaker is the destination.

ANOTHER PLACE

I need to go to the bank.

The bank is another destination.

WITH SOMETHING

Please bring your notes to our meeting.

The notes move toward the shared meeting.

Read each example. Explain what the highlighted choice means in context. Then cover the example and say a similar sentence.

Check your understanding

Write before looking at the answers. The guide gives a model answer and explains the choice. Other wording can be correct.

1. You are at home inviting a friend. Complete: Please ___ over.

2. You are leaving home for class. Complete: I must ___ my book with me.

3. Can come refer to the listener's location?

Use it in your own life

Invite someone somewhere and say what to bring.

Self-check

Does your sentence express your intended meaning? Does its form follow the relevant pattern? Can a reader understand the context?

Try again

After checking the explanation, revise your sentence. Say it aloud or use it in a short conversation.

Answers and explanation

1. come

The friend moves toward you.

2. take

You carry the book away from your current location.

3. Yes: I am coming to your office.

The viewpoint can be the listener or a shared destination.

One possible response

Come to my house for lunch. Please bring a drink.

This is a model, not the only acceptable answer. Assess meaning, grammar, and context together.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-11.html